



APES

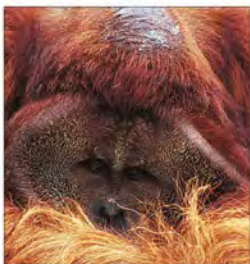
There are four sorts of apes: chimpanzees, orangutans, gibbons, and gorillas. They all live for many years, have big brains and no tails, and can walk upright. Apes are the closest relatives of people.



Playful



Begging for food



Orangutan (male)

Gorillas are the biggest and strongest apes, but they are gentle giants. Chattering chimps are sassy and cute, but much more dangerous—they even kill deer and monkeys to eat! Family life is important to all of these intelligent animals; chimps cuddle and shake hands when they meet.

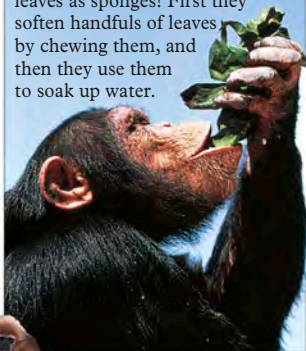
Playtime

Baby chimps take a long time to grow up. Their mothers feed them milk for five or six years—so they have plenty of time to play.



Brainy beast

Chimps are one of the few animals to use tools. They use leaves as sponges! First they soften handfuls of leaves by chewing them, and then they use them to soak up water.



Go bananas

Gorillas really do eat bananas. They also like nettles, giant celery, and banana leaves.

Walk like an ape

All apes can stand on just two feet, but they usually walk on all fours like this.



Apes walk on their knuckles.

